



Figure 1: Attaching the Ubuntu ISO file to the VM



Figure 2: Ubuntu is now running in your VM

the creation of the virtual hard disk. It will show you another summary—for the VM—hit **Create** here as well. That completes the VM creation. Now set the VM to boot from the Ubuntu ISO file to start installation.

In the VirtualBox main screen, select the just-created VM and click **Settings** on the main toolbar. Click the **Storage** tab and select the optical disk icon under **IDE Controller** (see Figure 1). On the right-hand side, click the CD icon beside **CD/DVD Drive: IDE Secondary** and click **Choose a virtual CD/DVD disk file...**; select the downloaded Ubuntu ISO file and click **OK** in the **Settings** box.

With the preparation done, let's start installation. With the new VM selected, hit **Start** in the main toolbar. VirtualBox fires up the VM and boots the ISO file. The Ubuntu splash comes up; wait till it loads the installer screen. On the installer **Welcome** screen, choose **Install Ubuntu**. On the checklist screen, click **Continue** after checking **Install this third-party software for MP3 codecs**. On the **Installation Type** screen, click **Erase disk and**

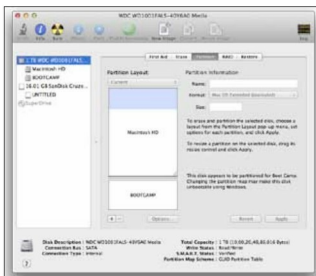


Figure 3: Resizing using Disk Utility

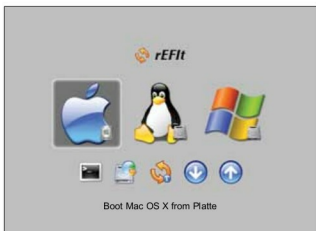


Figure 4: The rEFIt boot menu

install Ubuntu (safe, since it's limited to the VDI virtual hard disk). On the next screen, simply click **Install Now**, and wait patiently as it copies files, installs, and configures hardware and the bootloader. In parallel, you will be asked for your time zone, keyboard layout and user credentials, which you need to provide.

Once the installer has completed, and prompted you to restart, do so. This brings you to your new Ubuntu installation running in the VM (Figure 2). This wraps up installation into a VM. After gaining confidence playing around with the VM, let's up the ante and go native. Adventure makes life exciting, after all. Read on.

Installing Linux on the Mac natively

Native ('bare metal') installation of Ubuntu on the Mac is similar to how it was done in the VM. The preparatory steps are what you need to be careful about. I will show you how to prepare your Mac to install Ubuntu (and will omit most of the installation process, since it's the same as above).